follow me like the moon

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/53581774.

Rating:
Explicit

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Perfuma (She-Ra), Scorpia (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Adora is Welsh, Catra is a ballerina, 1980s, Alternate Universe - 1980s, London, Catra does burlesque on the side and it's hot, Adora is an eager baby gay and it's hot, Hurt/Comfort, Emotional Hurt/Comfort, Homophobia, Happy Ending, Queer History, Childhood Trauma, Overcoming Trauma, Adora has parents, Catra finds happiness, scorpia is a good friend, Past Violence, Aftermath of Violence

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Part 2 of the good life

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by the_deaf_pomegranate

Summary

It's 1980s London, and ballerina Catra's miserable until Welsh country girl Adora stumbles into her dance class. Yet what seems like a harmless flirtation quickly turns her life inside out.

Sequel alternative POV to my fic 'she walks me through the night' - you'll need to read this first! Light 1980s angst with a happy ending inspired by yet another brilliant Sammy Rae & The Friends' track, the eponymous 'Follow Me Like the Moon'.

Catra never thought she'd be so turned on by a Welsh accent, but it turns out she's discovering new things about herself everyday. She's too slow to react though - the lead instructor catches her eye, and Catra realises they're already running late. She'll have to be quick.

"Nothing wrong with your arse," Catra smirks when her voice makes the blonde startle, brushing past her purposefully as she makes her way to the front of the class, "Posture is another story, though."

Catra knows she doesn't need to stretch - she's certainly not going to do anything strenuous teaching a beginner's class - but she can't resist showing off a little now she knows she's got that girl's attention. If there's anything Catra knows how to do, it's tease.

Notes

Hi, lovely friends! I was so touched and blown away by the response to 'she walks me through the night' that I had to

write this alternative POV with Catra's story. It's a little more angsty but I hope you enjoy it just as much.

See the end of the work for more notes

Being back in London is shit.

Catra hates the boredom that comes with finishing a tour. It's lonely, waiting for another evening to dwindle away in her tiny bedsit after months of sharing hotel rooms with colleagues. With every week she spends waiting for *Nutcracker* rehearsals to start, Catra feels her muscles get more restless. Worst of all, she hardly gets to dance at all.

There's no other reason she'd agree to assist in Sergei's studio - apart from the extra cash, of course. Her teenage self would scream if she saw her crawling back to his Soho studio. How many years had she cried herself to sleep following his punitive critiques, begging her parents to let her train elsewhere?

It had been a thoroughly ludicrous pipe dream. Catra's parents had only ever been supportive of her potential, not of her needs. The past five years of zero communication had made it impossible to pretend otherwise.

Sometimes it's hard to ignore their perspective. Thanks to their pressure - however much she'd refute it publicly - Catra's only twenty-two and she's already scored her first soloist role. And just like her parents prophesied the last time they spoke to her, Catra's watched more than a handful of friends and colleagues waste away before her eyes. Gorgeous, vibrant boys who loved dancing as much as she did; whose own families were just as painfully removed and judgmental as hers. On tour, she doesn't notice the absences so easily.

There's no escaping reality now. Until winter, she's stuck with Sergei.

Her only respite - if she can call it that - is Kitty Bomb. There's always a slot for her if she wants it on Perfuma's slate, and Catra loves the way burlesque makes her feel. When she's up on that stage, whether she's wearing tassels or garters or basically nothing at all, Catra's even more powerful than she is in a tutu.

She can look around a room of beautiful, colourful women and know that every single one of them covets her. That they see her full, uncompromised self the same way she sees theirs. Kitty's a character in some ways, but in others, she's more Catra than Catra's allowed to be in real life.

One day, it would be nice to find someone who might like all of her, who wants all of her, without an ounce of Kitty's help. Still, Catra's a realist - in this day and age, she'd be lucky to have anyone at all.

On Tuesday mornings, Catra assists in her least favourite class: Adult Beginners . It's not a very accurate title - most of the students have dance experience but didn't sign up fast enough for the oversubscribed intermediate course - and Catra hates watching them compete to impress Sergei.

Except today… Today there's a tall, lost-looking blonde dithering awkwardly at the back before class begins. She seems like an actual beginner, and Catra bites back a scoff as she watches the girl stride up to the barre mirrors to inspect her makeup - she's clearly never been in a dance studio before.

Yet Catra is silenced pretty quickly when the blonde swipes Carmex on her lips with unparalleled precision. In seconds, she's terminally transfixed on the manipulated corkscrew curls of a perm and long, sinewy limbs. It's been a long time since anyone caught Catra's attention like this, and it makes her take a chance. She strolls around the perimeter of the studio, settling the nervous flutter that's building in her belly before she gets close to the woman.

"This is what I get for listening to my agent," the blonde grumbles under her breath, right as Catra's about to introduce herself,

“Improve your posture, my arse.”

Jesus Christ.

Catra never thought she’d be so turned on by a Welsh accent, but it turns out she’s discovering new things about herself everyday. She’s too slow to react though - Sergei catches her eye, and Catra realises they’re already running late. She’ll have to be quick.

“Nothing wrong with your arse,” Catra smirks when her voice makes the blonde startle, brushing past her purposefully as she makes her way to the front of the class, “Posture is another story, though.”

Catra knows she doesn’t need to stretch - she’s certainly not going to do anything strenuous in a beginner’s class - but she can’t resist showing off a little now she knows she’s got that girl’s attention. If there’s anything Catra knows how to do, it’s tease.

Bingo.

Even without Kitty’s tricks, Catra makes blondie’s jaw gape open. And when the girl’s so engrossed in the lines of Catra’s body that she forgets herself, speaking aloud out of turn, Catra’s sure that her gaydar’s working properly. She makes a few more corrections than is technically necessary when she notices her fingertips leave a slew of goosebumps on the blonde’s skin, though it’s hard to deny that this girl is possibly the worst dancer Catra’s ever had the pleasure of teaching.

It’s a disappointing surprise when Catra sees her running away as soon as the lesson ends. It’s a fight to push away old thoughts - to stop herself from thinking that the chemistry between them is only in her head - but Catra calls after her, chasing her down before she leaves the room.

By the time Catra’s established that this girl is deeply infatuated with Sigourney Weaver, has more than a passing interest in Catra’s tits, and that she’s been direct enough about where she

works for Catra to assume it's an invitation, the aching tug in her chest has given way again to.

Fuck, is she looking forward to Tuesday mornings now.

"What's up, Wildcat? You seem kinda down."

Catra rolls her eyes at Scorpia's observation, buffing more blue pigment onto her eyelid. "When am I *not* down?"

Scorpia takes the bait, peering at the dressing room mirror as she combs her hair back like David Bowie's, "Well… You weren't down when you were cast as a soloist, or when Kitty got a standing ovation at Christmas. And you were uncharacteristically chirpy last week…"

"Chirpy?" She's sure she's lost her eyebrow, it's risen so high.

"A Catra version of chirpy," Scorpia concedes.

Catra sighs, setting her eyeshadow palette down on their shared dressing table and pulling her satin dressing gown a little tighter around her.

"You haven't heard of anyone new on the scene, have you? Welsh girl?" Catra asks, even though she already knows the answer. Perfuma always tells her and Scorpia about the fresh meat first, and there's not enough single lesbians their age in London for a gorgeous newcomer to go unmissed.

"I don't think so," Scorpia glances at Catra sideways. It's so obvious she's trying not to express her intrigue too keenly; she's desperate for Catra to open up.

She grunts, realising that she's piqued Scorpia's interest too much to wriggle her way off the hook. Catra's going to have to spill. "I thought I might have met someone at the studio. Tall and blonde. She was giving me all the signals."

"That's exciting!" Scorpia's enthusiasm makes Catra frown, "What signals?"

"To start with, she spent the best part of an hour ogling my bum and staring down my leotard. But I'm probably imagining things. She hasn't been back in over a week."

"She could still turn up."

Catra smiles softly, shrugging before she runs red gloss over her lips. "I don't think so. She was a terrible dancer, to be honest."

Scorpia hums under her breath. Catra knows she's doing it to give her a break - they've been friends for long enough for Scorpia to know that sharing this kind of information isn't easy for Catra. When they met - both of them baby queers huddling furtively in the corner of the school grounds - Scorpia had dirty blonde hair that cascaded down her back, and a motormouth that filled all the silences Catra left between them. Back then, it was Scorpia who had ignited Catra's love for femmes, whose fumbled bedroom kisses had exiled seventeen-year-old Catra from her family home forever. Still, even history failed to preserve Catra's desire once she'd thrown herself into the professional ballet world. There was no space for Scorpia's suffocating affection between the emotionless one night stands Catra favoured while touring. For a while, she found satisfaction in colleagues in search of an experiment, and soon, Scorpia found Perfuma.

Catra's glad for it. The last thing she needs is another reason to feel guilty for living the way she sees fit. Besides, if Scorpia hadn't found Perfuma and adopted her obsession with self-expression, Catra never would have discovered Kitty.

She could still turn up…

Scorpia's words play on repeat in Catra's mind all night, even when she's on stage. She finds herself searching the Crimson Waste crowd for a permed blonde ponytail or a set of grey-blue eyes, though Catra knows if her Welsh girl turns up, she'd probably be crowded from view by other women anyway.

"She told me where she works. Some video shop near the studio," Catra admits in the early hours on the way home, sure that Scorpia can't hear her over the sound of Perfuma's wheezing old car engine.

It's a foolish assumption. When they pull up outside Catra's crumbling building and she leans into Scorpia's open window to say goodbye, she's got a smile on her face like a death knell.

"So, tomorrow you're going to wear your shortest skirt and your shiniest nail varnish, and we're going to show her what she's missing."

Catra gawks at Scorpia. She can't be serious.

"Scorp-"

"I'll meet you outside Foyles at twelve. See ya!"

Perfuma cackles as they drive off sharply, robbing Catra of any chance to object. She's got no choice but to go along with it now - Scorpia will be working all morning with zero access to a phone.

"Fuck."

Okay. Catra *does* look fucking hot. Even Scorpia blushed when they met on Charing Cross Road, and Scorpia's seen Catra in absolutely nothing at all.

“Just play it cool, okay? Don’t make it weird.”

“Weird?” Scorpia scoffs, “Pssht. I don’t make things weird.”

“Yes, you fucking do,” Catra snaps as they cut through Old Compton Street, “Remember when I was seeing Starla, and you-”

“Oh,” Scorpia interrupts airily, “I *liked* Starla. It’s such a shame she-”

“Got hitched to a yuppie asshole called Tim?” Catra growls, “Yes, I know.”

Scorpia quietens, her cheeks blushing. Tact has never been her strong point, especially when it comes to Catra’s failed relationships. She can never stay mad for long though. Not when Scorpia always seems to know what’s best for her, and Catra wants to believe (so badly) that today’s little trip is no exception.

“This is it,” she says when they reach the little shop, lilac paint covering every inch of its front. Scorpia slaps her ass for luck as she opens the door to enter but Catra’s so wired, she hardly notices.

The second they get in, Catra immediately notices the blonde at the counter. She’s totally focused on the small TV player, and Catra doesn’t need to look up to recognise Irene Cara’s voice blasting from its tinny speakers. Her eyes are much better served looking at the woman’s exposed abs peeking out from under a cropped *Wham!* t-shirt.

What a feeling, indeed.

Scorpia pulls her further into the shop and hustles her into an aisle just as a purple-haired girl - *why is everything so bloody purple here?* - elbows the blonde in the ribs. Catra isn’t sure what her deal is. Maybe she’s the boss, or just really fucking annoying, but she’s clearly trying to get Catra’s girl to do her job for her.

Scorpia pretends to look at video cases, umming and ahhing when she spots a blockbuster that she hasn't seen in a while. Catra plays along, pretending she gives a shit about *Sixteen Candles* and the *Breakfast Club* , though if she's honest, she finds Molly Ringwald very annoying. Since Starla, a lot of redheads annoy her.

Catra looks over her shoulder and sees the blonde shifting back and forth on her toes. She seems to be nervous.

Interesting.

Like magic, one of the few explicitly gay films Catra knows of suddenly presents itself on the shelf to her. It's time to strike.

Watching her terrible dancer's eyes widen when she turns into the shop aisle and approaches the counter is more delicious than Catra could have imagined. She takes wider strides than usual - her skirt rides up and reveals her burlesque garters (wearing them was a last-minute stroke of genius) - and blondie practically chokes on her own spit.

Catra slides the video case slowly towards her when she reaches the counter, positioning her clipped painted fingernails in clear view.

"Have you seen it?" Catra asks the blonde pointedly, hoping that she'll catch the bait. It's her best bedroom voice and it sounds strangely sterile when it bounces off the linoleum flooring, "I've heard it's good, but I'd be more confident if it had your recommendation."

"I… I haven't seen it. Not for any particular reason or anything, I just haven't gotten round to it."

Catra takes in the nervous wreck in front of her. She's getting increasingly sure of the effect she's having on the other woman, that if she cuts the tension at the right time, she'll come tumbling into Catra's metaphorical arms.

“Relax,” Catra smiles at her, grazing the blonde’s hand with her fingers when she picks up the video case, “I didn’t mean anything by it.”

“Oh, okay. Tidy,” Catra could stare at that deep blush forever. Unfortunately, Scorpia decides it’s the perfect moment to sidle over and push her arm through the crook of Catra’s.

“Have you got it, Wildcat?”

“Yup.” Catra doesn’t take her eyes off the startled blonde when she answers, “Just talking to my friend here.”

“Adora,” the girl finally introduces herself by thrusting her hand out to Scorpia. Catra likes the sound of her name. It’s uncommon like hers, but more musical somehow. Adora. It fits the flowing trill of her Welsh accent, “Lush to meet you, it is.”

She zones out of Scorpia’s rambling until her friend commits a cardinal sin, “Is *this* the Welsh girl you told me about? You should invite her to the show!”

Catra can tell she’s blushing now and she’s absolutely furious. She knows she’s supposed to be working on vulnerability, to get Perfuma to shut up about her emotional constipation if nothing else. But this is too far. In one sentence, Scorpia has ruined Catra’s aloof flirtatious persona and made her look like a pathetic obsessed teenager!

“Yes,” Catra says, her teeth gritted. She’s determined to win back her dignity, “Adora is a one-time pupil of mine.”

“Pupil?” Adora laughs in Catra’s face and it’s so shocking and so wonderful that Catra nearly laughs back, “I didn’t realise you could promote yourself to instructor!”

“Funny. I didn’t realise anyone could ever need as many corrections as you did,” Catra offers a wry smile when she responds, making sure to roam over Adora’s exposed stomach. It isn’t often she sees muscles like this on someone who isn’t a

dancer. She thinks it's only fair to give Adora an opportunity to see more of her too, "Maybe you should come to the show. You might learn something."

Adora gulps, and Catra feels satisfaction settle in her gut. She's momentarily distracted by Adora's co-worker sidling closer to them, clearly snooping in on her business. Catra doesn't want this sequin-smeared gnome - *okay, they're probably the same height* - anywhere near her beloved bar. Spaces like the Waste are sacred.

"Thursday night at the Crimson Waste, ten o'clock. Scorpia's singing," Catra instructs, before she leans in close to Adora, her eyes trained territorially on the purple-haired girl, "Don't bring the glittery freakazoid with you."

"I heard that!"

Catra hears the girl's outraged retort when she's leaving the shop with the VHS tucked in her handbag, and it makes her laugh freely for the first time in ages. She winks at Scorpia and puts her sunglasses on, screaming back a quick second before the shop door slams shut behind them.

"Eat my shorts, Sparkles!"

It's Thursday, and Catra's secretly terrified that Adora won't turn up. It would be the ultimate humiliation if her gaydar turned out to be irrevocably broken, let alone if Adora *is* gay but thinks Catra's grosser than a bovril sandwich.

She's up last this Thursday - Catra is sure Perfuma's set the running order this way on purpose, the asshole - but she can't bear to sneak into the bar like she normally does and greet her friends in the audience. Catra's a realist. She won't have the brain function to talk to the blonde if Adora actually comes, and she

won’t have the resolve to talk to anyone else if Adora doesn’t. She tries not to think about the fact that she’s never been this nervous about a girl before, ever.

My insides are like a fucking pretzel, and it’s disgusting.

It turns out Catra doesn’t need to worry so much, not when Kitty’s there to take over her body and tease every single lesbian with eyes into submission. Even in the dark, Catra feels the intensity of Adora’s gaze on her. When she finally finds her in the crowd, her blonde curls visible above everyone else’s heads, Catra’s smile spreads wide with satisfaction. Adora’s jaw has dropped wide open, her pupils entirely blown out.

Catra was pretty certain her ass and her tits were capable of moving mountains, but thanks to Adora, she’s now one thousand percent sure.

The only problem is, when Catra shimmies into her tightest jeans and slinks into the bar, Adora is nowhere to be found. She folds herself onto another woman’s lap and brings a martini to her lips, determined not to let Scorpia or Perfuma know she’s disappointed.

All Catra needs to focus on is that she’s actually caught a gay in the wild. Next, she needs to make her stick around.

The following Thursday, Catra *does* peek into the bar while she’s getting ready for Kitty’s performance. Adora’s in the same spot, perched on a barstool and looking thoroughly uncomfortable as she casts her eyes around the crowded room. Catra’s deprivation plan has worked exactly as she wanted - she avoided Bright Moon Rentals all week to starve Adora of her presence - and now she’s primed for dinner.

She tells Scorpia that she’ll have to owe Perfuma a favour for bailing and starts to take Kitty’s neon yellow lingerie off, before deciding that maybe her alter ego could lend a helping hand. When Catra wriggles into her trusty denim boilersuit and pulls the

zip up to her ribs, she's surprised at how good she looks, mixing these two worlds together. She could do it a little more often.

Catra's pulse begins to race when she sneaks around the perimeter of the Crimson Waste, waiting for the perfect moment to approach Adora. It goes against every instinct she usually has, but Catra doesn't want to rush in and spoil this. Adora's only wearing a vest top and acid wash jeans, and her exposed biceps seem to draw Catra closer and closer. She appreciates Adora doesn't seem to notice any other woman - hopefully that means she's only returned to the Waste for Catra - and the more she zones in on those skittish blue-grey irises, the more Catra's sure there's nothing that could drive her away. All she wants is to drink the Welsh woman in and slowly savour her.

"You're getting comfortable there, princess," Catra puts on her best Kitty voice as she climbs onto the barstool beside the blonde, anticipating the warmth of Adora's gaze to wash over her, "Came back for more?"

Adora's head turns to Catra's face first but it's mere seconds before she's zeroed in on her visible bra. She blinks several times like she's never seen another woman's tits before. It's cute, though Catra hopes it's not reflective of how practised she'll be with her hands (Catra can't believe she's already thinking so much about how practised Adora might be with her hands).

"You're not performing tonight? You were amazing last week!" Adora finally responds, her praise coming out in a flustered rush.

Catra grins, though she tries to hide it. One of them has to at least *try* to play it cool.

"Can't give away the goods every time," she jokes, "There's far too many pining women and not enough lesbian burlesque dancers for that."

"So you are, then?" Adora asks carefully, her eyes flitting back and forth nervously between Catra's face and the floor, "A lesbian?"

Catra leans in close, her gut starting to twist uncomfortably. This is not the tone of questioning she'd usually expect from someone comfortable in gay spaces. She can't deal - *won't deal* - with another Starla situation. It's taken long enough, but Catra's finally starting to believe she's worth more than being someone's delectable guilty pleasure. She's got to suss Adora out, even if it hurts.

"What about me possibly suggests that I'm not?" Catra tries not to narrow her eyes but she's totally unsure if she manages to keep a neutral facade up.

Adora seems to blanch and blush at the same time. Her lip trembles for a second, and her eyes travel up and down Catra carefully like she's trying to take in every inch of her while she has the chance.

"Well," she says slowly, and Catra's teetering on the edge of a cliff, waiting to find out if she'll freefall or fly, "You're my first one. Lesbian, I mean. I don't know what… How people like that are."

Shit.

Catra's a fucking idiot. She's walked right into this stupid trap all over again, all because she can't bring herself to find someone who's actually gay - who can live with it - and give them a chance. How many women had asked Kitty out since she started coming to the Waste? Surely one of them must be able to show her a good time, if not more.

The only problem is, when Adora fidgets like that, all shy and nervous, and she looks at Catra like she might just hold the answer to the universe, it's near impossible to do the smart thing and walk away. This girl might not realise she's a lesbian, but Catra knows what longing looks like and how it feels. Right now, Adora's lusting more over her than Maggie is over the mine closures. It's only polite for Catra to spend a little bit of time with her. The gay gods would think it's a good deed, that's for sure.

If nothing else, maybe she'll decide lesbians aren't a bunch of weird degenerates if she gets to know one.

"Hmmm. I think if you'd figure it out quite easily if you tried," Catra says, suppressing the string of desire pulling from her fingertips to her core when she tugs Adora to her feet, "Come out for a couple of hours. Promise I'll show you a good time."

Everything hurts and Catra can't sleep.

It's impossible not to replay what just happened over and over again; to turn off the megaloop of Adora's hands and lips chasing every bare spot on her body. She'd been so convinced the blonde would run away long before they got to this. But every time Catra looked behind her, Adora was staring at her like she was the point of a compass. It made it impossible for Catra to tell her to go home when they'd reached her bus stop. So the bus to Camden had raced past them, and Catra had practically no choice but to go to the only other place she had a set of keys for. The place that she hated and loved so deeply that there was no way of ruining it with a stupid mistake.

But when she remembers how Adora pouted once Catra let go of her hand to open the studio - and God, her expression made Catra want to swallow her whole under the silvery moon - anguish blooms fiercely and suddenly inside her ribcage.

You've never kissed a woman, she'd said, and Adora had clearly taken it as such a challenge that she kissed Catra like she'd never been kissed before. She'd licked the inside of Catra's mouth while her hand crept between the softness of flesh and denim, fingers grazing over the flimsy lace of Kitty's yellow bra. Adora's breath had hitched the first time the pad of her thumb met a hardened nipple, a strangled noise escaping her gullet. She liked it when

Catra bit down on her neck, so much so that she'd dedicated what felt like hours to marking Catra with her own bites. They hadn't gone as far as they could've - as far as Catra has to stop herself from wishing they'd gone - but here she is, tangled in Adora's arms at dawn, her head rolling sorely on the polished wooden floor.

Catra can hear every tick of the studio clock taunting her. She shouldn't still be here, especially not with a girl, but something about Adora makes Catra hesitate.

Just another five minutes, and then I'll get a taxi home.

Adora's chest rises and falls gently, and it lures Catra back to her every time she decides to leave. It's unbelievable the blonde has fallen asleep at all. Catra's never been more uncomfortable. Still, she doesn't move for hours, and Catra stays until they're cutting it so fine that panic starts to creep into her chest.

What if Sergei finds me here with her, and he does exactly the same thing they did? I can't lose the studio too.

She can already feel the hard pull of her mother's hand on her scalp and the sore bruise that will form on her cheek if she doesn't get Adora out in time.

Catra scrambles to her feet hastily, not bothering to see if it hurts Adora when her limbs slide off Catra onto the hard floor.

"Quick, get up," Adora squints in confusion when Catra wakes her, her body heavy and slow as Catra hurriedly pulls the blonde to her feet, "The early classes will come in."

She tries not to acknowledge her accelerating heartbeat when Adora's eyes roam over her bare skin again, and she zips her boilersuit to the top after noticing the tiny bruises that snake up her collarbone and neck. Catra knows if she looks at Adora, she'll hardly be able to stop herself from kissing her again. Instead, she focuses on herself, attempting to fix her dishevelled make-up in the mirrors.

“Catra,” Adora speaks at Catra so breathily that it’s almost enough to make her moan, “Come back.”

Catra rolls her eyes playfully, determined to suppress her fragile emotions. “Why don’t you come here, princess? You could do with some cleaning up yourself.”

Adora ducks her head and ambles over. She lets Catra rub at her face, though it isn’t long until Catra gives up and sacrifices her favourite sunglasses to the cause of Adora’s dignity. The blonde doesn’t react the way she expects; instead of wilting with fatigue, she puffs up with pride, clearly emboldened by the idea of wearing something of Catra’s.

I’ve got to do something to shut this down. It’s too dangerous.

“I’ve got a spare leotard to wear in the closet but you’ll have to leave,” Catra says emotionlessly, fuelling her words with as much authority as she can, “I can’t get caught at work.”

“Can I see you again?” Adora asks. She sounds a little more eager than Catra expects, and the pleasant surprise makes her forget herself for a second.

“Maybe,” Catra answers, teetering on her tiptoes to press their lips together briefly. It’s only a peck, but the magnetism between them is as horrifyingly brilliant as it was in the early hours, “If you think you’re up to it.”

“Why wouldn’t I be up to it?”

“You’re not the first ‘straight girl’ I’ve had a bit of fun with,” Catra sighs deeply, bringing her fingers up to carve quotation marks around her accusation, “But I’m no-one’s dirty plaything.”

“‘Straight girl’? What else am I?”

Catra angers. Adora’s response is right out of Starla’s playbook and there’s no doubting how this is going to go if Catra lets herself be swept along for a ride again. Next up will be anger and

denial, and when she can't bear to lie to herself any longer, Adora will move onto deflection.

"Don't play dumb, princess. Do us both a favour and figure out what you're doing."

Catra regrets it as soon as she says it but when Adora trembles and flinches, she knows it was the right thing to do. She clutches at the thought as she tells Adora how to sneak out into the alleyway next to the studio and splashes water on her face in the ladies' loo.

When Kitty performs to everyone but Adora the next week, Catra knows she made the right choice.

Even though it's her fault, Catra's still disappointed by the absence of Adora.

In no time at all, the blonde had ripped a tall, five-foot-ten hole in her consciousness. It doesn't matter how many jumpers Catra throws over the overdue *My Beautiful Laundrette* VHS box, or how many routes she conjures up to avoid walking past the rental shop on her way to the bus; Catra thinks of Adora constantly.

For several weeks, Catra feels like she's going through the motions: *stretch, train, teach, dance, sleep, eat, chores.* She fixates on Starla, and her parents, and the siblings who haven't spoken to her in years, and there's hardly anything that anyone can say that interests her.

The only saving grace is that Perfuma doesn't try to play therapist and Scorpia leaves her alone to stew. Catra's given them the short of it, that Adora was dead end and she shouldn't have gotten swept up in the idea of her. She tells them that she's never going to bother with anyone she meets outside of a gay space again

and that she's finally learned her lesson. It's easy to say - she's starting rehearsals for *Nutcracker* in a few weeks and then she'll be gone again. Catra doesn't need London, and London doesn't need Catra either.

Yet right when Catra's convinced she's finally made peace with all of it, Adora comes back.

"I'm not a straight girl," Adora tells her in the tiny dressing room after kissing her, barely loud enough to hear, "I'm a Catra girl… And maybe a Sigourney girl too."

There's no way Catra's resolve is strong enough to resist Adora, even after everything. She wants more and more - *unlimited* - kisses, and she'll dig her fingers into golden curls to prove it. Faster than ever before, Catra feels hot liquid pool between her thighs, and all she wants to know is if Adora's feeling the same thing.

The blonde stands in front of her, magenta lipstick stained all over her mouth. Catra licks her thumb and smooths it over the gorgeous mess before applying the colour to Adora's lips afresh.

"Beautiful," she says, only just able to stop herself from gushing more. Adora's eyes crinkle with unexpected delight, and Catra knows then and there she isn't going to be able to usher them out of the Waste subtly. No, she wants to show this off.

Despite the satisfaction of hoarding everyone's attention, Catra likes it best when they make it out the bar and Adora watches her the very same way as she did the last time. Catra may as well have hung the moon in the sky when she tugs Adora's hand in hers, leading the blonde away from Soho to her Camden home. They wander one footstep at a time instead of getting the bus; there's no reason not to stretch the night out as long as it will go. She sings under her breath without realising, though when Adora leans in closer and squeezes her palm tight, Catra feels encouraged to carry on. She's never let herself be heard like this before.

“You can touch me anywhere you want to,” Catra says when she stands in front of Adora, who sits on Catra’s bed like she belongs there, her lips swollen from Catra’s kisses, “I’ll tell you if I change my mind.”

“Anywhere?”

“Anywhere,” Catra confesses uncharacteristically, “I’ve been daydreaming about you touching me for weeks.”

Adora’s eyes widen as she nods, though she shifts nervously on the mattress. “What if I do it wrong?”

“You won’t,” Catra’s so wet that she’s sure she’ll come whatever Adora does, “But if you need any help, I’ll show you how I like it.”

Adora nods again and reaches out for Catra’s waist. She unzips Catra’s jeans, her breath shuddering when she runs her palms along Catra’s hip bones, and pushes the denim down until it crumples on the floor. She unfastens the poppers of Catra’s fuschia bodysuit and kisses the flesh of her thighs; when Adora’s little finger catches on the gusset of her underwear, they both gasp. Catra can feel the heavy dampness of the fabric and she kicks her jeans off her feet to widen her stance a little, silently begging Adora to fill the gap.

“It’s happening to you too?” Adora murmurs, and Catra’s head spins a little at the thought of Adora feeling as needy as she is.

There isn’t much time to dwell on it before she’s distracted again. Adora pulls Catra’s underwear to the side and slides two timid fingers between Catra’s folds, their tips ghosting Catra’s entrance as they move back and forth. Catra rolls her head back, placing a shaky hand on Adora’s shoulder. She exhales with effort, air hardly able to force itself in and out of her lungs. Adora pauses, eyes flicking up.

“Sorry, I’m probably terrible-”

“Don’t apologise,” Catra’s eyes flutter shut. She knows if she even tries to look at Adora, she’ll lose herself too fast, “It’s good. Really good.”

Adora’s fingers return to where Catra likes them, though she’s surprised when she hears the blonde’s voice again.

“I want to see you, Catra.”

Adora’s other hand moves from Catra’s thigh to the dangling hem of her bodysuit and eases the fabric up, and Catra rushes to pull the colourful spandex over her head. When she opens her eyes, Adora’s staring at her tits, her fingers frustratingly stilled.

“Are you just going to look at them?” Catra tries to tease but her voice sounds strangled.

She isn’t sure what she expected, but Catra’s thoroughly unprepared when Adora shakes her head and tugs the lace of her bra cup down, swirling her tongue around Catra’s hard nipple.

“Fuck, Adora. I thought you were new to this.”

The blonde sucks at the same time that she restarts a fervent rhythm in Catra’s underwear, her open mouth pressing hot kisses to her breast.

“G-gentler,” Catra stammers, her hand moving to grip Adora’s nape.

Adora jerks back hurriedly and Catra has to grip harder on her shoulder to hold her in place, “Shit. Sorry.”

“Don’t stop,” Catra whimpers, “Just… a little slower down there. Touch me how you touch yourself.”

That seems to ignite determination in the blonde. She trails kisses down Catra’s breasts to her navel and pushes her thumb past the fabric of Catra’s underwear to circle her clit.

“I like it here,” Adora offers shyly, “Do you?”

Catra doesn’t suppress a moan from bleeding out her throat. She drops to her knees on the mattress and straddles Adora’s thighs, sinking onto the blonde’s palm. She rolls her hips, groaning at the feeling of Adora’s broader touch. Catra knows she probably isn’t going to last much longer. Adora is possibly the least confident lover she’s ever had, but her earnestness sends tingles through Catra’s body. She tilts her hips again and again, and then Adora bites down on her neck right at the same time that she pushes her finger into Catra and curls them towards herself.

Though Adora looks at Catra like she hung the moon, Catra knows already that Adora will make her see stars.

Adora proves herself to be more of a top than Catra predicted. As the weeks pass by, she grows increasingly confident; her drive to understand all of Catra’s body steals countless hours from them.

“Aren’t you tired, princess?” Catra asks when the wells of Adora’s irises submerge blue into black for the third time in one night. She should have known this would happen when she wandered into the rental shop and Adora looked at her so hungrily that she locked the empty shop up ten minutes early.

Adora pouts, her hand coming up to Catra’s jaw. It’s the first time Catra’s stayed in Adora’s bed overnight, and her forearm is sore from biting down to quieten herself. She turns her face to kiss Adora’s palm, inhaling the scent of dewy fields and vanilla that surrounds her. Catra doesn’t know how Adora smells like this, but it’s like she’s brought the entire Welsh countryside with her to London; a whole alien world that she’s suddenly got a personal portal to.

“I can’t get enough of you,” Adora admits bashfully, and Catra swears her heart skips a beat, “Everything about you wakes me up.”

Catra runs a hand over Adora’s back, the skin there covered by a thin sheen of exertion.

“What if I help you get to sleep? You have go-sees tomorrow.”

Adora nods, and she lets Catra pull her into place on the pillows; Catra splays her hand across her little spoon’s belly and starts to trace soothing circles that travel from her waist to her thighs and back again. Adora moans contentedly, her hips shifting when Catra’s fingers graze the crease of her groin. Catra follows Adora when she opens her thighs, snaking her hand lower to stroke gently where Adora’s yet to let her do much.

“Okay?” Catra whispers into Adora’s ear and gets an impassioned grunt of assurance in response.

Adora drives her ass further into Catra, her head rolling backwards when Catra kisses the back of her shoulder and migrates upwards, drawing Adora’s own wetness to circle her hardened clit lightly. Adora shudders, another moan escaping her.

“Quiet, ‘Dor,” Catra whispers and takes Adora’s ear lobe into her mouth. She’s learned easily enough that Adora loves it when she does this, “Be a good girl for me.”

Catra listens for every suppressed sound that Adora stifles in her throat and the changes in her rising chest. She isn’t aiming for fireworks but for swelling waves, for pleasure that floods and foams and soothes. When Adora whimpers, her belly trembling under Catra’s hold, she knows it’s more than satisfaction of a good job spreading in her chest. She has to stop herself from freezing - Adora’s fluttering, she still needs Catra’s touch to hold her through the come-down - when the word she’d given up on tries to force itself on her tongue.

Love.

She tells herself the giddy warmth simmering in her veins is nothing more than bravado. That wanting Adora to experience the best of everything, wanting her to feel *cared for* , is only a strong sort of mutual kindness. Love is a ludicrous concept.

Yet when Adora does soften and limp in Catra's arms, her body rocked inside and out to sleep, Catra can't think of a word that feels more right. She imagines what it would be like to have the house and the picket fence, and the kids that pump their fists in the air when they nail a basic jeté for the first time. But Catra's heart breaks just as it swells. These are not things her and Adora will ever have. That thought is even more ludicrous than any thoughts of love.

Catra forces herself to think of pretty things instead of sheep to get to sleep. There are worse visions than Adora's creamy stomach, or her flushed cheeks, or the tiny mole that nestles above her left hip bone.

She wakes to Adora's lips on her cheek and a thigh sliding between her own. Catra giggles, last night's realisations briefly forgotten. They can't have long until she needs to go. It's Saturday, and Adora's sure her flatmates won't emerge from their poorly concealed sex cave until the late morning, but Catra's never been one to take risks with narrow margins.

"I should go," she says breathlessly, her words so far removed from her wants.

Adora groans miserably but she doesn't stop Catra from slipping out of the bedding, her eyes trained on Catra's skin as she searches for her clothes in her duffel bag.

"Don't get dressed," Adora says when Catra fastens her bra. She knows it's Adora's favourite, turquoise like her blue eye, and so thin you can see her nipples through it, "We still have a little more time."

Catra can't say no to Adora's hopeful expression. She rolls her eyes and climbs back onto the bed, settling on top of the covers and sitting with her back against the wall so she can rake her fingers through golden hair. Adora's eyes are still sleepy, last night's eye shadow smudged over her pillows, though it's nothing compared to the stains of Catra's lipstick on her mouth, chin and neck. Adora reaches out, her nakedness spotlighted by the sun streaming through the curtains, and touches the tender bruises she left on Catra's stomach. They've had to be strategic - Catra's started *Nutcracker* rehearsals, and she's thoroughly unwilling to let any of her new colleagues glimpse the love bites - but Catra melts a little as Adora proudly surveys her work.

"Head's up, freakazoid, I'm coming in!"

Catra feels Adora's shriek before it reaches her ears; Glimmer - apparently this is the name of the glittery purple asshole she works and lives with - barges into the room, her foot knocking their emptied beer bottles over. Glimmer's eyes roam over all of it, taking in Adora's nakedness and Catra's lingerie, and Catra's suddenly so petrified that history will repeat itself that she doesn't even attempt to stop the flinch that overtakes her face.

Hands. Scalp. Slap. Cheek.

She pulls her knees to her chest, praying that it'll stop.

"Adora?" Glimmer's cautious voice swims in Catra's ears, "What's going on?"

Adora doesn't say anything. Catra suppresses a shiver. She was right all along - Adora's just another straight girl afterall, and this is the end of all of it. The end of them.

But when Adora *does* speak, it isn't what Catra expects.

"Exactly what it looks like. Is that a problem?"

Catra squeezes her fingers, more to convince herself that she isn't being kicked to the curb than to reassure Adora. Not that she'd

admit it.

“Adora,” Glimmer responds, her words tinged a little with hurt, “We live in Soho. Do you really think this would shock me?”

Catra’s calming down, but she isn’t going to be okay until she gets out of here. She should never have been here for this conversation, however proud she is of Adora for being honest. Besides, telling Glimmer doesn’t mean Adora really wants Catra.

“I should go. You have to talk.”

Catra shudders as she launches herself off the bed and reaches for her clothes. Both Glimmer and Adora stare at her with varying degrees of lust - Catra smirks involuntarily once she notices - and she realises that if this is goodbye, she may as well relish the attention they’re devoting to her. She reaches out for Adora’s fingers, not quite able to believe this isn’t a final goodbye. Catra doesn’t want to torture herself by indulging in the hopes of anything more.

Yet Adora has other ideas. Unexpectedly, she tugs Catra to her, pulling her close to capture her lips. It’s not just any kiss - it’s slow and lingering, and it convinces Catra that telling Glimmer has made Adora even more committed to her.

The little voice in the back of her mind says *love* again, and Catra’s so happy and relieved she almost floats out of the flat.

Since Glimmer found out about them, Adora’s become even more enthusiastic about their relationship than before. It helps that Glimmer and Bow - Adora's other weird colleague-slash-flatmate - have finally given up on their pretence of secrecy, and no-one's tiptoeing around anyone anymore.

Catra hardly sees her own place; Adora always has a reason why it's more logical for Catra to sleep in her bed instead of going home. Still, Catra doesn't miss it, not nearly as much as she misses Adora's touch when she is alone. Since her mother, no one has ever tended so devotedly to her bruised toes and blistered skin, clipping her toenails short and straight, and pouring Epsom salts into a washing up basin so Catra can soak her soles. As each exhausting day of rehearsals passes, Catra pushes away the thought that *Nutcracker* will start touring soon. She's never had a reason to make her days in London stretch before, but now the thought of leaving doesn't fill Catra with relief quite the same.

On rare occasions like today - when rehearsals wrap up and Catra isn't totally devoid of energy - she tries to pay it back. Adora's become borderline obsessed with whiling her nights away at the Crimson Waste, to the point that she's gotten far friendlier with Perfuma than Catra ever really did. Whenever she joins Adora there (a performance from Kitty is a very rare sighting now), her arms always wrap territorially around Catra's waist, and something akin to belonging threatens to swallow her.

Catra holds her mobile phone to her ear and leans on the doorway of Bright Moon Video Rental, adjusting her leotard so Adora can see the bruise she'd left at the top of Catra's right breast a couple of nights prior. It has the intended effect; Adora's attention is caught wholly and in seconds, their phone line's been cut off.

"Can I help you?" Adora asks mischievously when Catra finishes her slow approach to the shop counter.

"I don't know. Can you?" Catra bites her bottom lip and Adora fixates so forcefully on it, she's surprised it doesn't burn a hole right through her, "I'm looking for something you might have in the back."

Catra knows there's only fifteen minutes to go until closing, and whatever customers are left will file out pretty soon, but she wants Adora's hands on her *now,* even if just for a quick fumble in the back. Adora scans the room, her resolve clearly faltering. She

leans forward over the counter to close the gap between them, her lips brushing Catra's ear. It's surprising how risky she's being given there's still customers there. Catra hopes it just looks like a kiss on the cheek; maybe they'll mistake Adora's Welsh accent for something European.

"I'll give you my key to the flat," Adora's voice is low and gravelly, and Catra starts to question if she should suggest they go to the Waste at all, "If you wait upstairs and get changed, I'll come find you once I've locked up and we can go to the bar."

"Sounds good to me, princess."

She turns sharply on her heel, swaying her hips as she walks out the shop. Catra doesn't have to see Adora to know that her eyes are closely trained on her ass.

When she lets herself in upstairs, Catra's surprised to find Glimmer alone on the sofa watching TV. They look at each other, unsure what to do or say, and then they both speak at the same time.

"Where's Adora?"

"You aren't out with Bow?"

Catra drops her duffle bag to the floor and shakes the keys in her hand. "She's locking up, she'll be up in a bit."

Glimmer nods, and they fall into silence again. It's never stopped being that awkward between them; Catra usually holes up in Adora's room and avoids her, and she's pretty sure Glimmer does the same. Bow's alright - Catra kinda likes him when he's not making too much of an effort to be supportive - and Catra can at least appreciate that they're both close with Adora. They've been more accepting of Adora's lesbianism than most might be too. Maybe she should try harder to get along with them.

"Adora says we're kinda the same, you know," Catra says as she perches on the far edge of the sofa, "Funny. Smart. Stubborn and

shit.”

Glimmer’s eyes flick up at her in surprise. She turns towards Catra, studying her closely, and it makes the hairs on the back of her neck prickle.

“I like how she is when she’s with you. I haven’t seen Adora this happy ever,” Catra’s stomach flips at hearing that, “Though you’re still kind of an asshole.”

“So are you.”

“I guess Adora’s right then,” Glimmer snorts, and it makes Catra snort too. Maybe they could stand to spend some more time together.

Catra moves from the sofa arm and settles on the cushions instead, turning her attention to the sight of Joan Collins in gold lamé on the TV screen. “Dynasty?”

“One and only. My mum got me into it.”

Catra nods, bringing her legs onto the sofa and folding them under her. “I watched the first series with mine. When I didn’t have to train, anyway.”

Horrifically, she sniffs. Glimmer holds out a packet of chocolate digestives but Catra declines. She hasn’t eaten a chocolate digestive since she left home. Well, since she was kicked out of home.

Glimmer frowns. “Come on. You must have danced enough to afford a biscuit, Catra. Adora’s always saying you need to eat more.”

“She is?” Catra looks at the biscuits again. “That’s not really why…”

Glimmer wiggles the packet.

“Okay! Alright,” Catra takes one, turning the biscuit over in her fingers. The smell reminds her of happier memories. She’d always assumed it would make her miserable, but when she bites into the digestive and lets chocolate spread over her tongue, the only thing she thinks of is fetching them from her parents on Sunday afternoons and handing them out to her younger sisters.

“See? A biscuit isn’t going to kill you.” Glimmer jokes, a smug smile flickering on her lips.

“Shut up and watch your show.”

Catra rolls her eyes but she doesn’t really mind. Sitting with Glimmer is more comfortable than she expected. Comfortable enough that she doesn’t notice the time until the episode comes to an end.

“Shouldn’t Adora be up by now?” Catra checks her watch, blanching when she sees it’s been over fifty minutes since she left Adora to lock up. Glimmer does the same, her face twisting in confusion, “I’m going to go check on her.”

Nothing prepares Catra for finding Adora whimpering on the shop floor, her eyes unfocused and her face bloodied.

“You should see the other guy,” Adora jokes weakly in response to Catra’s dismay, though her bravado doesn’t stop her from crying, “I should have been more careful.”

Catra presses her lips together, disappointed that Adora’s so intent on shielding her that she isn’t able to be honest about how shaken she is. It’s true that Catra’s overly cautious - she’s had enough bad experiences to teach her a lesson - but that was never the impression she wanted Adora to have of her. Catra’s proud of who she is, isn’t she?

“I’d never let you get hurt, Catra. I promise.”

That makes Catra think about it a little differently. She’s always had to look out for herself, but now… Now she doesn’t have to

deal with the world on her own. Adora's already proved it over and over again, and Catra's determined to make sure Adora never gets hurt again either.

"Oh," Catra chuckles softly, leaning forwards to kiss Adora gently. She chases Catra's lips instinctively when they break apart, stealing another peck, "You're lovely when you take a stand. But I'd be much happier if you didn't get another shiner."

Adora's machismo dissolves the minute Catra gets her upstairs and into bed. It's a miracle she manages to fetch everything she needs to treat Adora's wounds so quickly; as soon as Glimmer agrees to leave them to it, Catra dry heaves in the bathroom, running the tap at full pressure so she can't be overheard. There's no time to dwell on all her fears while Adora needs her.

"Shhh. I've got you, princess," Catra soothes Adora as she cries, her teeth hissing when TCP stings her broken skin, "You'll book more gigs than Linda Evangelista once we've patched you up."

Adora blinks, her eyes a little glassy as she focuses on Catra. "I'm going to fall in love with you and no-one will even know."

"I'd know."

Catra's heart races a little at what Adora says. *Love.* It's possibly within reach, or at least, she thinks it might be. She puts the TCP and cotton down and gestures for Adora to sit up, letting her own waves down to pull back her girlfriend's hair and tie it up with her scrunchie. She may have been subconsciously avoiding it, but this conversation had to happen sooner or later.

"Adora," Catra starts, though it takes her a second to figure out what to say next, "It gets easier, living like this. And maybe one day, it'll be different anyway. There's loads of people at the Waste who go to protests and stuff. They're adamant things can change."

By the time she's finished her sentence, Catra thinks she actually believes it. Maybe for the first time.

“I don’t need government permission to love anyone. I won’t let my life be lesser for it, and neither should you.”

Adora stares at her like she’s written a whole new Bible. It seems like her brain is whirring at eighty miles an hour, a billion thoughts flitting through it.

“I wish you weren’t leaving so soon,” Adora says eventually, her hand reaching out for Catra’s own.

Catra smiles, her fingers closing in and locking them together. “I’ve never much looked forward to coming home when I’m touring. It’ll be different this time. I’ll hardly wait.”

It’s the day that Catra’s leaving, and Adora’s huddled in Catra’s emptied bedsit, barely able to let her go.

“I can’t be late, ‘Dor,” Catra runs her hand through Adora’s hair, “The coach leaves in half an hour.”

“I don’t want to lose you,” Adora confesses, her eyes filling with tears, “What if you forget about me in Paris? Or Berlin?”

Catra sinks to a kneel, meeting Adora on the living room floor and wrapping her arms around the blonde’s shoulders. She’s never felt this sure about anything before, not even about ballet.

“I won’t forget about you. Adora. I love you.”

Adora blinks in surprise, her pupils searching Catra’s irises as if she’s a hallucination. “You love me?”

“Yes. I… I love you, Adora.”

“I love you too. More.”

“There’s no such thing as more.”

“There is. And I love you that much.”

She’s not certain who starts the kiss, but Adora feels so good against her lips that Catra wonders if she could spend forever in this embrace. And then she realises that she could ask for it.

“Can you find somewhere for us, for when I get back? Just ours?”

“Yes,” Adora answers breathlessly, her smile evident against Catra’s cheek, “I’ll find us a home. The best one I can.”

Adora makes good on her promise, and then some.

After her parents learn the truth about them and things don’t implode as much as either of them were expecting, it’s suddenly a lot easier to take each day as it comes. They write letters home to Wales, outlining all of Adora’s go-sees and Catra’s teaching gigs, and they always get a reply.

Catra tries to send some letters too, one to her parents and another to each of her sisters. She waits a month, then three, and there’s never anything in the post back. It’s painful, but somehow not so terrible when Adora scoops her into her lap and lets her cry. Catra doesn’t regret a thing when she declines her second soloist role and watches the company go away on tour again for *Sleeping Beauty.* Not many of her colleagues know or understand why, but Catra feels relieved for the first time when she thinks about giving up the travel. Ballet’s still ballet wherever she is, but Adora can only be in one place at any given time.

Two years later, when her girlfriend finds the thin metal bands Catra had been hiding in her duffel bag, her immediate instinct is to lie.

“It’s not what you think it is,” she says, conscious not to come across too strong, “I just… They’re…”

She can't come up with a reasonable excuse. Adora narrows the gap between them, rolling one of the rings between her thumb and forefinger.

"I was *hoping* they were for us to wear. And then anyone who needs to would know you're mine, and I'm yours."

Catra gulps. Is it possible Adora really wants this as much as she does?

"Really?"

"Well," Adora says, her lips meeting Catra's forehead and murmuring against it, "A few folks at the Waste reckon marriage could happen one day. Maybe not for decades, but one day."

Catra scoffs. She's never genuinely believed it was possible deep down. Not in this country, anyway.

"You once told me you didn't need government permission to love anyone," Adora continues, "What changed?"

She draws back and cups Catra's face in her hands. It's not that different to their very first kiss - though Catra buts in before Adora gets the chance.

"Marry me, then. Or fake marry. Whatever," Catra's words rush out like a river breaking through a dam, "As long as you say y-."

"Yes," Adora interrupts her gleefully, "Yes, I will marry you, Catra Horde."

"Good."

"Good," Adora repeats, a smile spreading wide across her face, "Very good, even."

Perfuma writes off their bar tab that evening, and Catra kisses Adora so fervently when she finishes her scheduled burlesque performance that she immediately worries she'll never get a

crowd for Kitty again. It's total paranoia - the entire room cheers for them when Adora pulls her down from the stage.

"See, wifey?" Adora whispers in her ear, "A wedding is a wedding."

There's a parcel with two bars of Dairy Milk and a five pound note through their letterbox the following week, sent by Adora's parents to congratulate them.

"You were right," Catra tells Adora as they curl up in bed, and she breaks off a piece of chocolate to place in her wife's mouth, "A wedding is a wedding after all."

It turns out a piece of paper means even less in reality than it ever did in theory. Catra knows Adora will follow her wherever she goes, and she'll spend her life grateful for it.

End Notes

thank you so much for reading! how do you think this compares to the first fic?

i would be so grateful to hear your thoughts and for any kudos you'd like to give :)

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!